

What are the features?

To start with, once you activate the p2 theme, you are faced with a Twitter-like interface. Make a post right from the front page (Figure 1)—be it a link, status update, a blog post, a video...almost anything that you would like to share with the group. Comments can be made in-line, and it will be shown to users with an AJAX-style pop-up, instantly. One feature that stands out when you compare this to other WP themes is the real-time updates. It reminds me of Facebook!

The default setting can come in handy for beginners, but after some tweaking, p2 can be made into a full-fledged group discussion channel, just like IRC and mailing lists. I found p2 comparable to a hybrid between mailing lists and Facebook.

Customising

p2's Recent comments: Widgets are handy when you are going to customise the p2 theme. You would want to show all the latest comments made by your team in a neat Facebook-like update on the right sidebar. So go ahead and add the p2 *Recent comments* widget. It has a nice on-hover description, so you get to know what others have commented by hovering over the comments.

RSS feed: A feed of recent posts would be a great addition to your p2 theme blog. It will give a broad idea about what's happening in case the discussion goes beyond a few dozen posts.

Announcements: Insert a text box or milestone onto the right-side bar, to announce to the group what's coming up. This comes in handy to remind everyone of the targets and deadlines to be met.

p2 options

A very good way to tweak your custom p2 blog is to work with the p2 theme options (Figure 5). You can use it to do the following tasks:

- You could set the comments thread to be either hidden by default, or not.
- The sidebar can be hidden, to give a full-width display to your blog. This is useful for a smaller number of people discussing some specific topic.

Apart from this, you get all the other default options that come from most of the WP themes, including a custom header, background and so on.

You can add more authoring members to your blog, and change p2 into a full-blown group discussion portal.

Is it for me?

This is a tricky question. After going through what p2 is all about, it's for you to decide if you want to make the switch or not. If you have a small team, a club, an interest group...and would want to connect and discuss everything online, p2 is the best choice. There's no need to follow the mailing-list

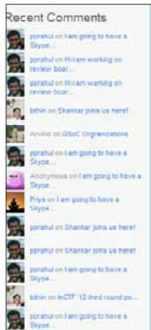


Figure 3: Comment-widget

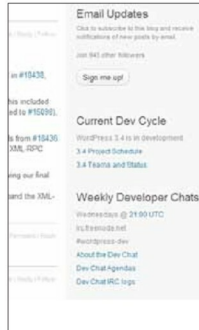


Figure 4: Announcements

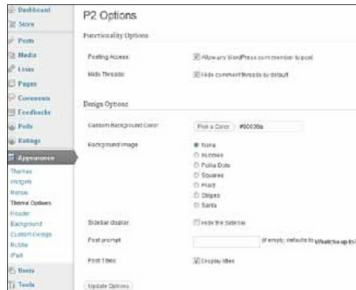


Figure 5: p2-options

guidelines. Moreover, you can insert all the interactive content on the go with p2.

It would be best to first decide if Google Groups or a Facebook group work for you—if you can get everyone connected through either of these options, your organisational communication works fine. Otherwise, it is worth trying out p2! 

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